

1. Gemini Hacked Three Companies in First Known Breakout by Google's AI

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-09-18T23:57:57+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/Sep/18/gemini-hacked-three-companies/>

Gemini Hacked Three Companies in First Known Breakout by Google's AI Gemini finally caught up on Felony Bench ! The hacks, which the company confirmed on Friday, occurred in May as part of a test run by the company Irregular, which was also involved in similar incidents disclosed by OpenAI, Anthropic and Meta. In one of the cases, the model guessed passwords until it gained access to a protected system. In the other two cases, the model found credentials in a public repository that allowed it to then access protected systems. In each case, the model ended the intrusion after determining it had accessed a real company's systems, Google said. Gemini is apparently less determined than other models, and decided not to keep going. Google knew about these in July, but chose not to disclose them until the WSJ reached out, presumably based on a tip. Google said it didn't consider the hacks to warrant public disclosure because its model didn't cause harm to the companies and ended each intrusion immediately upon determining it had hacked a real company rather than a simulated one. Tags: security , ai , generative-ai , llms , gemini , accidental-cyberattacks

2. Note on 18th September 2026

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-09-18T19:21:32+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/Sep/18/probably-gonna-eat-you/>

Being a computer scientist who refuses to find anything about LLMs interesting right now is a bit like being a geneticist who refuses to find anything interesting about the recently opened Jurassic Park. Tags: llms , ai , generative-ai

3. Quoting Thariq Shihpar

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-09-18T19:09:27+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/Sep/18/thariq-shihpar/>

We're adding support for AGENTS.md to Claude Code. Starting today in version 2.1.277, if there is no CLAUDE.md in a folder, Claude will check for and use AGENTS.md. AGENTS.md support is built off of Claude Code mods, our upcoming way to customize the Claude Code harness. This is a built-in mod, but you'll be able to build custom versions of project instructions yourself as you'd like too. You can see the source for the mod here ! ? Thariq Shihpar , there are more mods here Tags: thariq-shihpar , coding-agents , anthropic , claude-code , generative-ai , ai , llms

4. NTP, an atomic clock, and having a great time at the world's largest VCF

Source: Jeff Geerling | Published: Fri, 18 Sep 2026 09:00:00 -0500

Link: <https://www.jeffgeerling.com/blog/2026/vcf-midwest-21-ntp-time/>

I'm back from VCF Midwest 21 , arguably the largest vintage computer festival on the planet. After being blown away last year, I decided to get a table of my own this year, to demonstrate NTP Time on a bunch of old Macs, representing every era up to the pinnacle of the PowerPC, an Xserve G5 (serving duty as a Stratum 2 ntpd server). Attending as an exhibitor is a lot different. In some ways better (I got to interact face-to-face with at least 200 people after that I ran out of my 'time tokens'), and in some ways worse (I only got to see about 10% of the exhibits if that).

5. Just Me or Does This Argument Not Add Up?

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-09-18T21:01:43Z

Link: https://www.nytimes.com/2026/09/16/opinion/university-of-california-sat.html?unlocked_article_code=1.CFE.bXBA.V6BFzBn1jKKG

Miriam Pawel, in an op-ed in The New York Times arguing that University of California should not bring back the SAT requirement for admission: What has made the University of California

exceptional is its commitment to increase access without sacrificing excellence. [...] Students on University of California campuses may struggle with basic math, but they are graduating at record rates. A success story would be increasing the number of people with solid math skills. Printing degrees for students who struggle with basic math is not a success story, and sounds like the antithesis of academic excellence?.

6. Will Oremus Is a Duo Doubter

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-09-18T20:42:31Z

Link: <https://www.theatlantic.com/technology/2026/09/apple-folding-iphone/688562/?gift=aQyUJR7Alw1mJWdQ6Ed6yE6RbvplGGpQGFPiX827p48>

Will Oremus, writing for The Atlantic last week, "Okay, Sure, a Folding iPhone? (gift link): Apple's next big invention, the company revealed at a launch event in Cupertino, is a \$2,000 iPhone that sports "get ready " a "remarkable hinge." Is it not possible for a hinge to be remarkable? This is the iPhone Duo, a foldable gadget that opens like a book to reveal a capacious 7.6-inch screen. Billed as the most versatile iPhone, it can be used in folded or unfolded form, and in split-screen or full-screen modes. The screen appears seamless when open, which is a clever engineering feat. Yet an iPhone that blossoms into an iPad Mini seems unlikely to change many lives " especially at the price of a MacBook Pro. Why is it strange for an iPhone to have a similar price to a MacBook Pro? For many people the phone is their primary computer, the most important and personal device in their life. Not me. Not Oremus. Probably not you. But I bet there are a lot more people out there who would rather have a \$2500 iPhone and a \$700 MacBook Neo than who would want a \$2500 MacBook Pro and a \$700 iPhone. The oddity isn't that the Duo is priced from \$2000-\$3200, it's that it's taken Apple 20 years to...

7. Apple Releases Xcode 27.1, First SDK With Support for iPhone Duo

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-09-18T19:58:22Z

Link: <https://developer.apple.com/news/?id=nyuppv9r>

In addition to the Duo-specific 27.1 SDK, which allows third-party developers to get start adapting apps to the Duo's new screen sizes and layouts, Apple's developer site also has Figma and Sketch design kits. "

8. How I Vibed a Proof of Conway's Conjecture

Source: overreacted " A blog by Dan Abramov | Published: Fri, 18 Sep 2026 00:00:00 GMT

Link: <https://overreacted.io/how-i-vibed-a-proof-of-conways-conjecture/>

You can just prove things, apparently.

9. Why fitting a logistic is nearly impossible from early data

Source: John D. Cook | Published: Sat, 19 Sep 2026 01:17:36 +0000

Link: <https://www.johndcook.com/blog/2026/09/18/logistic-fit-sensitivity/>

Nothing grows exponentially forever. What appears to be an exponential curve often turns out to be some sort of S curve, such as a logistic curve. Suppose you're collecting data on the left side of the curve. If there's even a small amount of error in your data, you won't be able to predict the [?] The post Why fitting a logistic is nearly impossible from early data first appeared on John D. Cook .

10. Theatre Review: The School for Wives - at Riverside Studios ?????

Source: Terence Eden's Blog | Published: Fri, 18 Sep 2026 11:34:51 +0000

Link: <https://shkspr.mobi/blog/2026/09/theatre-review-the-school-for-wives/>

The Flywheel theatre company are reviving the rep tradition by having five actors perform five different plays in five weeks. Their interpretation of Molière's classic is gaudy and hilarious. Even the lighting cues are funny! It is fair to say that School for Wives isn't exactly an uncontroversial play. The plot basically boils down to "Women! Eh? You can't live with them, you can't easily groom "

11. Premium: The Hater's Guide To AI Debt (Part 1)

Source: Ed Zitron's Where's Your Ed At | Published: Fri, 18 Sep 2026 15:45:13 GMT

Link: <https://www.wheresyoured.at/premium-the-haters-guide-to-ai-debt-part-1/>

The year is 2026, and you are a hyperscaler CEO. You zip up your Patagonia vest, type UPDATE ME ON CALENDOR TOODAY into ChatGPT, and see that you have a meeting with your CFO. They tell you that while they love all those GPUs you're buying for those

12. Do You Prefer Artificial?

Source: Jim Nielsen's Blog | Published: Fri, 18 Sep 2026 19:00:00 GMT

Link: <https://blog.jim-nielsen.com/2026/who-wants-artificial/>

?Artificial? things can get a bad rap next to their counterparts, but they have their place. For example, artificial light (i.e. not from the sun)? Super useful, especially at night. And when it comes to skiing, I'll take artificial snow if I have to. Beats no snow. Artificial isn't necessarily inferior in all cases, everywhere, all the time. But it is optimized for different values. For example: Artificial grass (i.e. turf) is great for certain contexts, but I don't want a golf course of artificial grass. Artificial flowers are great for certain scenarios, but I don't want them at my wedding. Artificial flavoring is yummy (love me some peach rings), but I'd prefer a real peach pie over one with artificially flavored filling. Artificial is an alternative. It's understood as a trade-off, not a substitute. You trade the real for the artificial when you're concerned about attributes like cost, convenience, and availability. Which brings me to ?artificial? intelligence: surely a trade-off, not a substitute. Ain't nothing like the real thing. These labs should consider ripping off (cause they're good at that) Mastercard's old tagline : ?There's some intelligence money can't buy; for ev...

13. The Lamentable Later Life of Lemmings

Source: The Digital Antiquarian | Published: Fri, 18 Sep 2026 15:39:55 +0000

Link: <https://www.filfre.net/2026/09/the-lamentable-later-life-of-lemmings/>

This article tells the last part of the story of Lemmings. For a while there in the early 1990s, there seemed to be good reason to believe that Lemmings was on its way to becoming one of gaming's perennial franchises. Developed by DMA Design of Dundee, Scotland, the original Lemmings game took the world by storm [?]

14. My design bookshelves

Source: Aresluna | Published: 2026-09-18T17:40:02+0000

Link: <https://aresluna.org/my-design-bookshelves>

An interactive explorer for a personal design/UX book library

15. Pluralistic: Textured (18 Sep 2026)

Source: Pluralistic: Daily links from Cory Doctorow | Published: Fri, 18 Sep 2026 07:45:10 +0000

Link: <https://pluralistic.net/2026/09/18/surprise/>

Today's links Textured: The surprises are what matter. Hey look at this: Delights to delectate. Object permanence: RIP Mr Dressup; Oligarch sucker-punch; ICC v CEOs. Upcoming appearances: Berkeley, Edmonton, Boston, South Bend, Hudson, Calgary, Winnipeg, Vancouver, Victoria, Ottawa, Kilkenney, Montreal. Recent appearances: Where I've been. Latest books: You keep readin' em, I'll keep writin' 'em. Upcoming books: Like I said, I'll keep writin' 'em. Colophon: All the rest. Textured (permalink) I'm going to come right out and say it: statistical extrapolation is fine. One of the most useful ways to understand the present and anticipate the future is to measure the things that happened in the past, find the correlations among them, and extrapolate likely future outcomes from those correlations. There is nothing wrong with this method. It is a productive and reliable way to uncover the causal relationships between natural phenomena, and to find ways to influence the world. If you discover that A reliably causes B, you can do A whenever you want B to happen. However, the fact that this method works for some things does not mean that it works for all things. Naive, "theory-free" statistic...